

Fix the portfolio's efficiency. Use the festival as the engine.

My first month as Music Creator Manager · Belle He · August 2026

“From your room to the main stage.”

1 · COACH BY ARCHETYPE

The portfolio's problem is **efficiency, not effort**: the most active creators are declining. Two failure patterns, two coaching plans.

2 · FESTIVAL AS ENGINE, NOT EVENT

A “Road to Pulse” **competition** recruits new music creators and gives existing ones the discovery they are starved of; one mechanic, two funnels.

3 · SUPPLY-FIRST METRICS

Revenue follows retention and discovery. **Leading indicators gate every dollar** of the \$80K budget, with a go/no-go checkpoint at week 4.

OBJECTIVES & BASELINE

Define the pond before fishing: vertical scope, baseline discipline, targets with a basis

Scope and metric conventions come first; every number later in this deck traces back to this page.

1 · VERTICAL DEFINITION & SIZING

- **Pan-music creators:** singing, instruments, DJ sets, production. Broad at the vertical level, precise per creator
- The five managed creators are the vertical's showcase anchors; recruitment extends to short-video musicians
- The definition sets the size of the pond: recruitable pool estimated from tagged music content (tooling + manual tagging)

2 · BASELINE DISCIPLINE

- Baseline = **7-day averages** at period start and end, outlier days (platform mega-campaigns) removed
- Success is read as **campaign period vs baseline**, never raw totals
- Key campaign actions are scheduled to **cover the measurement window**, not drift past it

3 · TARGETS, WITH A BASIS

- **Vertical:** daily streaming actives and daily revenue, both up vs baseline
- **Campaign top creators:** revenue +100%+ during campaign, paying-user share +30-40%, per-payer spend +20-45%, follower growth
- **ROI $\approx$ 5-6x:** campaign-period revenue $\div$ \$80K (convention to confirm)

Targets come from comparable-campaign history and get locked against internal baseline data in week 1. **A target without a baseline convention is an opinion.**

Back the winners, fix the leaks: one verdict per creator

Hours and growth run inverse; revenue per LIVE hour spans \$62-\$318 (5×). Portfolio: \$62.1K total, weighted MoM −3.4%. MoM 0.09/0.22 read as +9%/+22%.

CREATOR	HRS	REV/HR	MOM	RETURN	VERDICT & KEY MOVES
Echo Music	38	\$318	+22%	48%	BACK · P1 — momentum is perishable. Fixed schedule; welcome rituals and fresh hooks for new-viewer conversion; fan-community VIP events (themed parties, birthdays, creator-planned) to consolidate paying users
Luna Live	58	\$303	+9%	60%	BACK — codify her playbook portfolio-wide; gentle hours increase. Balance can also mean a ceiling: content review before scaling
DJ Nova	115	\$123	−18%	81%	FIX — refreshed show formats and new segments; off-peak tests; festival stage slot as a new-audience injection
BeatTheory	90	\$116	−7%	75%	HOLD — prevention: run Luna’s playbook, one new-format experiment per month, alert on early echo-chamber signals
Vinyl Nights	126	\$62	−20%	87%	FIX — fewer, better hours (126 → ~80); new show formats; co-streams with rising creators; creator×fan second-creation missions

These five generalize to three patterns: **leaky-bucket risers**, **discovery-starved loyalists**, **balanced**. The actions suit creators whose data is stable but needs a breakthrough or a stop-loss; avoid homogenizing content. Execution reality: **keep a 10% backup roster**, outreach never converts 100%.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION I WOULD REQUEST

Internal tier standards (top / mid / tail / new) and where these five sit · the five creators’ actual content profiles · ROI and measurement conventions (campaign vs baseline?) · traffic-source split, payer concentration, 90-day trends

HOW I MEASURE COACHING SUCCESS

Per creator: streaming actives & hours, watch UV, follower growth · revenue, paying-user share, per-payer spend · watch → pay conversion

One festival, three funnels: recruit the new, energize the existing, showcase the top

The plan: “**From Your Room to the Main Stage**” · the **Road to Pulse Creator Program**, in five phases. Excitement isn't a separate workstream; it's the output of the other three, clipped and amplified.

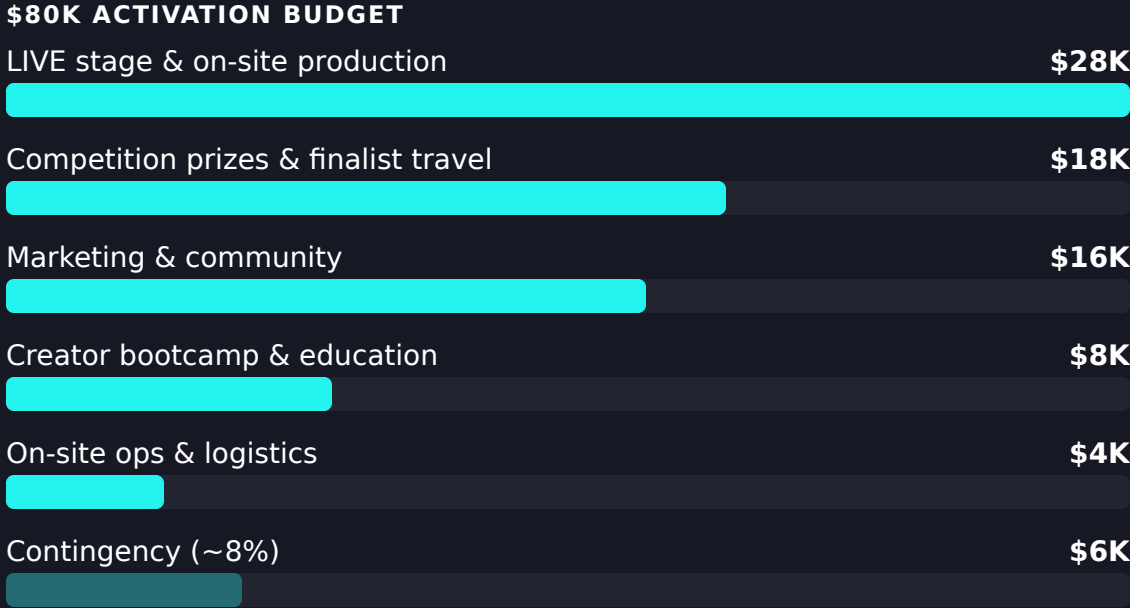
- 1 · Sign-up & warm-up
- 2 · Launch
- 3 · Online rounds
- 4 · Festival weekend
- 5 · Post-festival push

RECRUIT · the Rising division of "Road to Pulse": a dedicated on-ramp for musicians who have never gone LIVE

ENERGIZE · existing creators compete in the Headliner division; 4-week bootcamp + archetype coaching

SHOWCASE · TikTok LIVE stage at Pulse: finals + top-talent performances, all streamed

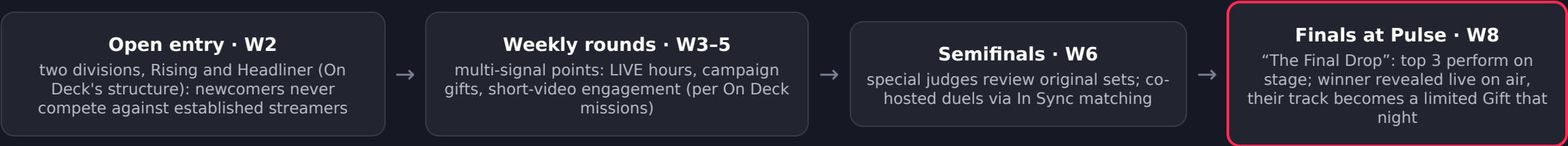
The budget is deliberately concentrated: the stage and the competition compound each other, and marketing amplifies a story the competition creates for free.



Creator-directed spend inside these lines splits ≈50% to top + high-potential creators (traffic boosts, content support), the rest to new-creator recruitment. Platform traffic and product support are in-kind, outside this cash budget.

"Road to Pulse", modeled on On Deck: Breakaway, with the entry gate the official campaigns don't have

Proven architecture, deliberately copied. My changes target what On Deck leaves open: recruiting pre-LIVE musicians, and day-31 aftercare.



THE REWARD LADDER (ON DECK'S DESIGN: CAREER CAPITAL OVER CASH)

WHO	REWARD	COST
All entrants	Pulse avatar frame + campaign badge	≈ \$0, platform asset
Round winners	Diamonds + festival merch	low
Semifinalists	VIP Pulse tickets, travel covered	the bulk of \$18K
Top 3	Stage slot + distribution support (as in Music On Stage) + own track released as a limited-run LIVE Gift (as in Songs of LIVE)	≈ \$0, priceless

Even On Deck's cash-equivalent prizes are modest: the top of the ladder isn't bought, it's platform access. That's why \$18K is enough.

INSIDE EVERY ENTRANT'S ROOM (ON DECK'S PRODUCTION MECHANICS)

- Campaign-exclusive **Pulse Gift** with in-room counter
- **Milestone progress bar**: gift-point thresholds unlock the next reward tier
- **Live rank badge** shown in the room; leaderboard resets weekly
- **Shout-out segment**: entrants thank top supporters on air, a built-in retention ritual

I watched these mechanics run live in On Deck rooms; they double as coaching material for the portfolio.

Runs alongside: education and the pipeline. A 4-week bootcamp covers streaming craft and the 1K → Gifts → Subscriptions → Rewards ladder, with portfolio creators as mentors. After the festival, every entrant enters a 30-day incubation track (first LIVE within 2 weeks, 3 streams/week by day 30). The festival is a pipeline, not a finish line. And On Deck itself runs different missions per tier; the platform already coaches by archetype, and I apply the same logic inside the portfolio.

Heat is engineered: seed it, spike it, then harvest it on site

On TikTok, hot lists run on derivative clips and planted moments. Nothing ignites from a cold start.

MAKING IT TREND

- **Anthem co-creation:** a star artist records the festival anthem in warm-up; creators cover it, fans duet it
- **Planted show moments:** engineered contrast pairings (AxB co-streams) turned into events, pushed with trending-topic words in 2-day concentrated bursts
- **Top creators post through the campaign:** participation $\geq 80\%$ is a tracked target; amplifier accounts scale the clips

CREATOR × FAN SECOND CREATION

- **Fan clip missions:** second-creation submissions ranked by like tiers, with reward ladders
- **Targeted, not broadcast:** offered 1v1 to high-stickiness, mass-fan creators; payer structure decides who runs fan campaigns
- **Open clip rights + attendee UGC:** booth QR prompts festival-goers to post; best fan clips hit the stage screens

ON-SITE & PARTNERS

- **Sponsorship** covers non-content site costs; stage & show programming curated from competition winners; creator-level QR attribution on stage and booth
- **Program team** is measured on qualified creators + platform heat; we deliver pre-event posting in return
- **BD team** assists recruitment; **product team** ships custom event effects; **labels** clear licensing from W1; VIP-ticket inventory and booth placement locked in the SLA

PROJECT PLAN

Kick off like an owner: results-based milestones, one weekly heartbeat



- ◆ **W1** kickoff: plan + budget + ROI aligned, one owner per workstream; creator 1:1s; licensing starts
- ◆ **W3** sign-up complete at target, campaign tested & live; offline prep starts ◆ **W4** entries go/no-go checkpoint ◆ **W5** qualifiers complete ◆ **W7** finals & logistics locked
- ◆ **W8** festival delivered ◆ **W+4** retention report

BIGGEST RISKS → MITIGATIONS

Music licensing gaps	Confirm rights + replacement tracks from W1; no uncleared set reaches the stage
Recruitment shortfall (entries or dropout)	Agency pre-commitments; 20-30% outreach over-provision + 10% backup roster; W4 checkpoint triggers paid boost
On-site tech failure	Redundant streaming setup + full rehearsal in W7
Gift-vote gaming	Judge-score gate + anomaly monitoring on voting patterns
Partner deliverables slip	SLA with weekly sync; stage specs frozen at W6
Budget overrun	8% contingency + weekly burn review
On-site content / brand safety	Dedicated moderation coverage for all festival streams; escalation path agreed with Trust & Safety in advance

STAKEHOLDERS

Internal: Product (custom event effects & tools), Data Science, Marketing, Legal & Music Licensing, Event Ops

External: Pulse festival org & program team (their metric: qualified creators + platform heat), BD / agency partners for recruitment, labels & artists

KEEPING IT ON TRACK

W1 kickoff alignment (plan + budget + ROI) · weekly standup · one owner per workstream · live dashboard on entries, coaching metrics, and budget burn

SUCCESS METRICS

Measure supply first: revenue follows

Targets are set from comparable-campaign history; week 1 locks them against a 7-day, outlier-trimmed baseline.

LAYER	METRIC	ILLUSTRATIVE TARGET
Leading · supply	Competition entries · first-time LIVE creators · portfolio quality-weighted hours · bootcamp completion	500+ entries; 150+ first LIVEs; completion ≥ 60%
Process · engagement	Music-vertical watch time during campaign · portfolio new-viewer share · average concurrent viewers	New-viewer share ↑ for Nova & Vinyl; ACV ↑ portfolio-wide
Lagging · revenue & health	Portfolio revenue MoM · revenue per LIVE hour · paying-user share · per-payer spend · campaign ROI · D30 retention of recruits	MoM positive by W8; payer share +30–40%; per-payer spend +20–45%; ROI ≈ 5–6×; D30 ≥ 40%
Guardrails · execution	On-site sessions delivered as scheduled · rights & safety incidents · budget adherence	≥ 90% delivered; zero material incidents; within \$80K

Supply and retention are the cause; revenue is the effect. I act on leading metrics and am judged by lagging ones.

WHAT LEADERSHIP SEES AT DAY 30

Diagnosis done, archetype coaching live

Competition running, entries vs. target at W4 gate

Festival logistics on track, licensing under way

Metrics dashboard live, leading indicators trending

Recommendation: approve this plan, subject to week 1 validation of baseline data, the rights inventory, and partner deliverables.